



AT LINCOLN and Sepulveda boulevards, there have been 99 collisions since 2010, according to city data.

The worst traffic crossings in L.A.

We identified the most troublesome intersections. Some may surprise you.

By Terry Castleman

Everyone who commutes in L.A. has a traffic choke point that is the very worst part of their drive — where everything stops, time seems to stand still, and you debate how many red-light cycles it's going to take to get through the intersection. It's these places where you worry about getting into that fender bender or witnessing an act of road rage that will haunt your nightmares.

The Times decided to find out which are truly the worst crossings in the city, based on city data on traffic volumes and accidents.

One surprise is that not all them were the crossings of major thoroughfares. Although those big intersections were represented — Pacific Coast Highway and Sunset Boulevard, Wilshire and Sepulveda boulevards — others included smaller streets. The reason? Often they marked key choke points just outside major attractions such as Hollywood, downtown Los Angeles and Los Angeles International Airport. Intersection design also plays a role. A poorly laid-out crossing can really back up traffic, especially in areas with few alternative routes.

James Moore, a traffic engineering expert from USC, reviewed The Times' data and offered some analysis, both predictable and surprising.

■ The common denominator for the list was clear: intersections at key traffic points, often near major shopping and business centers as well as freeways.

■ Many of the worst intersections were designed to handle a lot of traffic. They've been optimized for car movement (so pedestrians, buses and cyclists come second to moving cars). This is controversial because some feel the city needs to prioritize getting solo drivers out of cars and onto mass transit and other alternatives. But most of these intersections lack protected bike and bus lanes.

■ As frustrating as the waits at these intersections can be, Moore argues that the city generally has done an adequate job of moving so many cars. He's skeptical that much more can be done short of the type of "congestion pricing" system being tried in New York and European cities, where drivers pay a toll for using certain roadways at peak hours.

[See Intersections, A6]

Money could decide Wasserman's LA28 fate

Olympic chief's fundraising ability plays into debate over whether Epstein fallout warrants resignation

By Dakota Smith

Behind the debate over whether Casey Wasserman should resign as the 2028 Olympics chief over 20-year-old correspondences unearthed in the Epstein files is a fraught question that has long haunted the L.A. Games: Will there be enough money?

A growing number of California politicians are calling on Wasserman to step down over steamy emails between him and Ghislaine Maxwell, a longtime companion to Jeffrey Epstein who later was sentenced to prison for luring minors to have sex with the financier. Wasserman apologized for the emails and said he knew nothing about the pair's

criminal behavior.

So far, the Olympics committee has backed Wasserman, with allies saying he's a strong leader and prodigious fundraiser. His supporters say L.A. needs to keep him on the job in part because taxpayers are responsible for paying any cost overruns or budget shortfalls from the \$71-billion Games.

The Olympics has a history of leaving host cities with big deficits, and LA28 organizers repeatedly have revised their expenses upward.

Some politicians are skeptical that Wasserman's role is essential to keep the finances on track and worry

continued publicity about the Epstein files could make some sponsors think twice before getting involved. In addition to sponsorships, the LA28 committee brings in money through ticket sales and licensing agreements.

Reynold Hoover, chief executive for the LA28 committee — the nonprofit leading the Games — on Monday doubled down on LA28's support for Wasserman, telling Reuters that sponsors aren't concerned.

"I was at a meeting in Dallas with a potential sponsor — hopefully we'll get them signed up — and it wasn't even raised," he said to Reuters. [See Wasserman, A8]

U.S. sues UC over treatment of Jewish employees at UCLA

By Jaweed Kaleem

The Trump administration on Tuesday sued the University of California, alleging that UCLA administrators "routinely ignored" and "failed to report" employee complaints of antisemitism since the 2023 Hamas attack on Israel and Israel's war in Gaza spurred a surge in pro-Palestinian campus activism.

The Department of Justice alleged in court documents that UCLA has an ongoing, "severe and perva-



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times
UCLA ignored complaints, the lawsuit says.

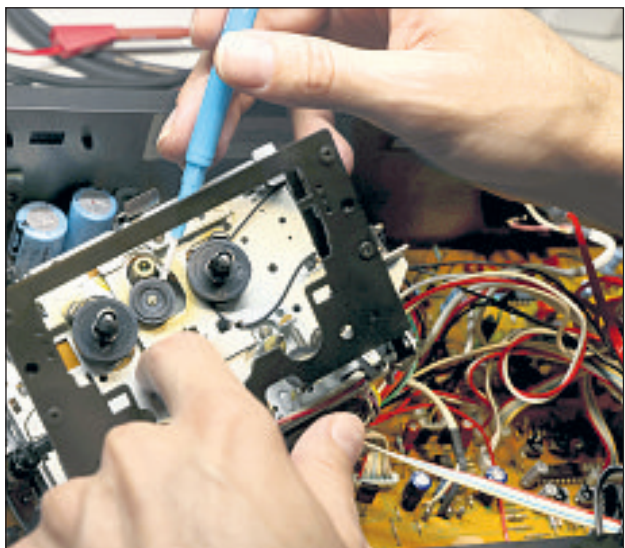
sive" antisemitism problem, citing pro-Palestinian protests — including one in January — that it contends are anti-Jewish or anti-Israeli.

"Based on our investigation, UCLA administrators allegedly allowed virulent anti-Semitism to flourish on campus, harming students and staff alike," U.S. Atty. Gen. Pam Bondi said in a statement Tuesday. "Today's lawsuit underscores that this Department of Justice stands strong against hate and antisemitism in all its vile forms."

[See Lawsuit, A8]

In digital-first era, he's plugging L.A. back in

By Oliver Wang



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times
SPENCER RICHARDSON repairs a Nakamichi tape deck in his studio in Los Angeles on Feb. 11.

Stepping into Jr. Market boutique in Highland Park is like entering a 1980s time warp. Built into a refurbished shipping container, it's filled with everything from tiny Walkman-style portables to colorful, number-flip clock radios and, naturally, boom boxes of all sizes. Few are more imposing than the TV the Searcher, a Sharp boom box from the early '80s that features a built-in, 5-inch color television.

"Try lifting it, it's really heavy," warns Spencer Richardson, the shop's owner. Indeed, the machine is at least 15 pounds without the 10 D batteries that power the unit. He adds, "I don't think you're taking this to the beach so you could watch TV while you listen to music."

An affable, hyper-knowledgeable proprietor in his early 30s, Richardson repairs and resells analog music technology from the 1980s or earlier. In bringing these rehabbed players

[See Cassette, A10]

Trump, in a weak position, projects power

President has challenges heading into midterms but isn't pivoting from his unpopular policies.

By Kevin Rector

President Trump headed into Tuesday night's State of the Union speech projecting confidence in his personal power to "Make America Great Again," despite the woes he says he's been saddled with by his Democratic predecessors.

He also stood in a uniquely precarious position — facing some of his lowest approval ratings ever, plummeting support on his signature issue of immigration, unrelenting pressure from the slow rollout of the Epstein files, a sluggish economy, mounting international tensions and looming midterm elections in which Democrats appear poised to make gains, possibly even retaking control in Congress.

Trump remains popular among his base and remarkably infallible in the eyes of his loyalist administration and still commands extraordinary deference from many leaders in his party. Many of his supporters share his con-

Late coverage of State of the Union

For a full report on the president's address, visit the e-newspaper or latimes.com.

fidence and suggest polls showing slipping support are bogus.

"This is what 'America first' looks like," said Paul Dans, former head of the conservative Project 2025 playbook, which Trump largely has adopted. "The last year has been phenomenal. He has done more in one year than most presidents would accomplish in a whole term."

Nonetheless, political observers see a landscape of vulnerabilities for the second-term president heading into this year's elections.

"He stands at a moment of rapidly declining political capital," said Rob Stutzman, a Republican consultant in California. "From a historical perspective, a president in Year 6, heading into what looks like a rough midterm, is probably not going to rise any higher again, in terms of their political equity — so he's probably past his peak of power."

[See Trump, A6]

Ex-fire chief files whistleblower suit

Crowley alleges Bass sought to shift blame for the city's handling of the Palisades fire.

By Richard Winton

Former Los Angeles Fire Chief Kristin Crowley is suing the city, claiming in a whistleblower lawsuit that Mayor Karen Bass "orchestrated a campaign of retaliation" to protect her own political future and paper over her failures during the most destructive fire in city history.

In the lawsuit, filed Monday in Los Angeles County Superior Court, Crowley and her attorneys allege Bass sought to shift blame for the way the city handled last year's catastrophic Palisades fire to Crowley amid mounting criticism of the mayor's decision to attend a ceremony in Ghana on

Jan. 7, the day the fire erupted. Bass, the suit alleges, left L.A. despite knowing of the potential severe winds and fire danger.

"She sought to avoid accountability by shifting blame and lying — including falsely claiming that she was not aware of the nationally anticipated weather event, falsely claiming that the LAFD's budget was not cut, and falsely claiming that LAFD's resources would have supported an additional 1,000 firefighters to fight the blaze — claims contradicted by public records and Bass' own prior statements," the lawsuit alleges. "These false statements were not mistakes but part of a deliberate strategy to divert scrutiny from Bass' decisions and to avoid accountability."

The Palisades fire took off the morning of Jan. 7, 2025, amid fierce Santa Ana winds, killing 12 people and

[See Crowley, A7]



JOE RAEDLE Getty Images

REWARD OFFER

Nancy Guthrie's family is offering \$1 million for information in her kidnapping. Above, Rachel Navarro puts up a flier in Tucson. **NATION, A7**

Slain capo had massive arsenal

Mexico's "El Mencho" relied on high-powered arms, hundreds of guards, drones for his security. **WORLD, A3**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 75/54. **B6**

Markets **A10**
Opinion Voices **A12**

Paramount bid may top Netflix's

Despite offer, Warner Bros. Discovery's board has yet to ditch bid by streamer. **BUSINESS, A9**

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